

Policy on Disciplinary and Grievance Handling

«Hospital Name»

Document control

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Prepared by	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Reviewed by	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved by	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

A blank marked _____ must be completed before issue.

Statement of intent

«Hospital Name» defines and implements a process for disciplinary and grievance handling, so that staff issues are addressed fairly, lawfully, and with a real path to redress.

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how «Hospital Name» handles disciplinary matters and staff grievances — the written guidance governing the mechanism, how staff know about it, the principles it follows, its legal basis, the appeal provision, and how grievances are redressed.

This policy does not cover recruitment, induction, performance appraisal, or staff health and safety — those are covered in other hospital policies.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all categories of staff at «Hospital Name». Grievances covered include workplace issues such as bullying and harassment.

3. Policy standards

«Hospital Name» has written guidance governing its disciplinary and grievance handling mechanisms, covering how cases are handled fairly, the legal basis followed, and the appeal provision — including workplace grievances such as bullying and harassment.

«Hospital Name» ensures the disciplinary and grievance handling mechanism is known to all categories of staff.

«Hospital Name» bases its disciplinary policy and procedure on the principles of natural justice.

«Hospital Name» keeps its disciplinary and grievance procedure in consonance with the prevailing laws applicable to its staff.

«Hospital Name» provides for appeals in all disciplinary cases, through an appellate authority higher than the disciplinary authority.

«Hospital Name» takes action to redress grievances and documents and communicates that action to the aggrieved staff member.

4. Non-negotiable rules

1. Do not run disciplinary or grievance handling without written guidance covering how cases are handled, the legal basis, and the appeal provision.
2. Do not leave any category of staff unaware of the disciplinary and grievance handling mechanism.
3. Do not decide a disciplinary case without allowing both the employee and the hospital to present their case.
4. Do not run a disciplinary or grievance procedure that is out of step with the labour laws applicable to this hospital's staff.
5. Do not deny a staff member the right to appeal a disciplinary decision to a higher authority than the one that made it.
6. Do not leave a grievance unaddressed — action taken must be documented and communicated to the aggrieved staff member.
7. Staff who see a rule under this policy broken report it the same shift to the HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer or the Medical Superintendent.

5. What we do

5.1 Written guidance

Written guidance governs disciplinary and grievance handling mechanisms at «Hospital Name», covering how cases falling under Sections 5.3 to 5.5 of this policy are handled, and including workplace grievances such as bullying and harassment.

5.2 Staff awareness

The disciplinary and grievance handling mechanism at «Hospital Name» is known to all categories of staff, who are aware of the procedure to follow if they feel aggrieved.

5.3 Natural justice

The disciplinary policy and procedure at «Hospital Name» are based on the principles of natural justice — both parties (employee and employer) are allowed to present their case before a decision is taken.

5.4 Legal compliance

The disciplinary and grievance procedure at «Hospital Name» is kept in consonance with the prevailing laws applicable to this hospital's staff category. An Internal Complaints Committee is established to handle complaints of sexual harassment.

5.5 Appeals

«Hospital Name» provides for appeals in all disciplinary cases, through a designated appellate authority higher than the disciplinary authority that issued the original decision.

5.6 Grievance redress

«Hospital Name» takes action to redress grievances through the written redress procedure; actions taken are documented and communicated to the aggrieved staff member.

6. Governance and responsibility

Role	Responsibility
HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer	Owns this policy. Maintains the written guidance and grievance redress records.
Disciplinary Authority	Conducts disciplinary proceedings in line with natural justice and applicable law.
Appellate Authority	Hears appeals against disciplinary decisions; is senior to the disciplinary authority.
Internal Complaints Committee	Handles complaints of sexual harassment.
Medical Superintendent	Oversees implementation of this policy. Receives escalations under Section 4.
All Staff	Know the mechanism and their right to raise a grievance or appeal. Report identified risks and rule breaches.

7. Quality monitoring

The HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer reviews disciplinary and grievance case records to confirm the mechanism is being followed. Documentary evidence is on file for the CORE objective element and the asterisked objective element. This policy itself is reviewed every year.

8. Training and staff acknowledgement

All staff covered by this policy are made aware of the disciplinary and grievance handling mechanism and sign the acknowledgement below.

I have read the Policy on Disciplinary and Grievance Handling of «Hospital Name». I will follow the processes described.

Staff name	Designation	Signature	Date
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

9. Distribution

HR department; all department heads / unit in-charges; all staff through the hospital intranet and department policy folders.

10. Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
HCO	Hospital (Full Accreditation programme under NABH Hospitals 6th Edition)
HR	Human Resources
HRM	Human Resource Management (NABH Hospitals 6th Edition chapter)
NABH	National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers
OE	Objective Element

11. Traceability to NABH HCO Full Accreditation 6th Edition HRM.8

This table is an index. It is not how the policy is organised. An asterisk in the Level column means documentation of the process is required.

OE	Level	Requirement	Where addressed	Responsible
HRM.8.a	Commitment*	Written guidance governs disciplinary and grievance handling mechanisms.	Section 3; 5.1	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer
HRM.8.b	Commitment	The disciplinary and grievance handling mechanism is known to all categories of staff of the organisation.	Section 3; 5.2	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer
HRM.8.c	Commitment	The disciplinary policy and procedure are based on the principles of natural justice.	Section 3; 5.3	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer
HRM.8.d	CORE	The disciplinary and grievance procedure is in consonance with the prevailing laws.	Section 3; 5.4	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer

HRM.8.e	Commitment	There is a provision for appeals in all disciplinary cases.	Section 3; 5.5	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer
HRM.8.f	Commitment	Actions are taken to redress the grievance.	Section 3; 5.6	HR In-Charge / Personnel Officer

12. Required Records / Evidence Checklist

HRM.8.a — Written guidance governs the mechanism.

- Written disciplinary and grievance handling guidance, covering how cases are handled, the legal basis, and the appeal provision.
- Workplace-issue inclusion record — bullying, harassment.

HRM.8.b — Mechanism known to all categories of staff.

- Staff-awareness record of the disciplinary and grievance mechanism, across all staff categories.

HRM.8.c — Disciplinary policy based on natural justice.

- Natural-justice-principle record — both parties heard before a decision — and disciplinary case record demonstrating the principle applied.

HRM.8.d — Procedure in consonance with prevailing laws.

- Labour-law compliance record for the disciplinary and grievance procedure, with a legal-currency review record.
- Internal Complaints Committee constitution record for sexual-harassment complaints.

HRM.8.e — Provision for appeals in all disciplinary cases.

- Appellate-authority designation record, higher than the disciplinary authority, and appeal-case record showing the provision was used.

HRM.8.f — Actions taken to redress the grievance.

- Grievance-redress action record, with documentation and communication record to the aggrieved staff member, and closure-tracking record.

13. References

- NABH Accreditation Standards for Hospitals, 6th Edition — standard HRM.8.
- NABH Guidebook to Accreditation Standards for Hospitals, 6th Edition — HRM.8 interpretations.
- Department of Personnel and Training, Government of India. (1965). Central Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules. <https://dopt.gov.in/ccs-cca-rules-1965> — referenced in HRM.8's own interpretation as an example disciplinary-rules framework.

Disclaimer

This document is a template prepared for the guidance of «Hospital Name» and must be reviewed, adapted and formally approved by «Hospital Name» before use. Every entry marked _____ must be completed before the document is issued.

The requirements in this document are accreditation requirements of the NABH Full Accreditation Standards for Hospitals, 6th Edition, not duties under a named Act of Parliament. Statutory duties that arise under other documents of «Hospital Name» remain those documents. «Hospital Name» is responsible for verifying any statutory duty that applies to it; this document does not constitute legal advice.

The clinical and technical content reflects recognised national and international guidance current at the date of preparation. «Hospital Name» remains responsible for verifying that it is current and consistent with the edition of the accreditation standard against which it is being assessed.

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